

AMERICAS ENGINEERING & CONSTRUCTION

GS Data Center Construction Spending Tracker: Texas leads, new markets emerge

Recent data center construction spending data show that the pace of investment has reaccelerated and our preferred leading indicators continue to provide visibility into spending levels two years forward that are well above today's run rate. At the same time, 2Q results provided growing evidence of returns on AI-related investments, while hyperscaler capex forecasts continued to move higher. As a result, we raise our 2026-2027 data center construction spending forecasts 10% on average to \$67 bn/\$87 bn respectively representing 35%/30% growth.

But national data center spending aggregates obscure one of the most important points for read throughs to our coverage: construction is a local business, and regional growth is diverging sharply on power availability, labor supply, and local opposition. In this edition of our tracker, we identify where capacity is actually being built and where announcement growth is fastest. We then map those trends against disclosed company footprints to assess the implications for our most data center-exposed names: FIX, LGN, and EME.

Our top three takeaways from our work follow:**1. Demand indicators continue to support robust data center spending growth.**

Data center construction spending accelerated to +46% yoy in June to a \$68 bn annualized pace, vs +32% yoy in May, with spending increasing ~18% over the last 3 months (a ~+90% annualized pace). Our preferred leading indicators remain constructive and provide visibility into spending levels ~ two years forward that are significantly above current run rates. Data center starts were up 528% yoy in July (189% yoy on an LTM basis), while announced projects now total ~4.5x times the number of projects currently under construction.

2. Capacity concentration and growth are diverging geographically. The top five states by data center capacity under construction account for ~60% of total data centers being built, led by Virginia and Texas. Yet none of these five states rank among the five fastest growing states by project announcements as growth is increasingly occurring outside traditional markets. Instead, the strongest announcement growth is occurring in Missouri, Oklahoma, Florida, Michigan, and Kansas, which collectively account for only ~6% of total announcements. Meanwhile, project announcements in Texas are still robust at >100% yoy while growth in Virginia has moderated to +9% yoy.

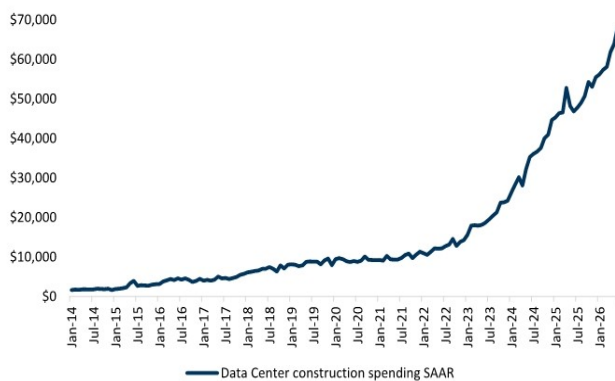
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3. Translating regional trends to company read throughs. Among our MEP coverage, EME offers the broadest craft labor footprint across data center markets, with meaningful positions in Virginia, Texas, Georgia. FIX provides the clearest leverage to Texas, while its growing fabrication platform and traveling workforce enable the company to pursue opportunities in more rural and emerging markets where it lacks a permanent local presence. LGN's participation in many of the fastest-growing data center geographies is primarily enabled through its fabrication business, while its installation workforce remains concentrated in its core markets of DMV, California, and Phoenix.

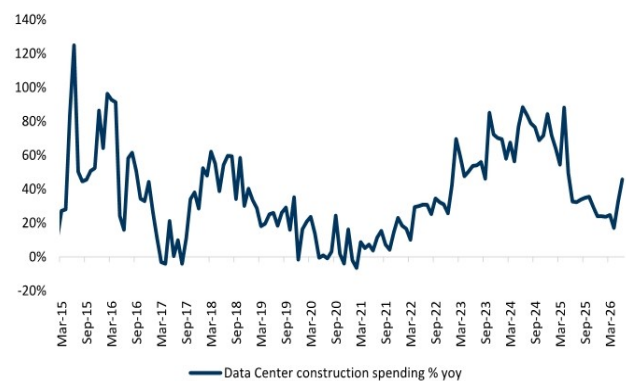
Exhibit 1: Data center construction spending SAAR
\$ in mn



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Census Bureau

Exhibit 2: Data center construction spending % yoy

In June 2026, data center construction spending was +46% yoy (vs +32% yoy in May 2026 and +33% yoy in June 2025)



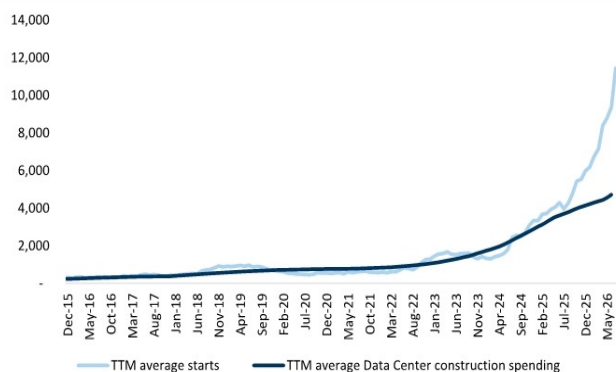
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Census Bureau

What do the lead indicators say about forward data center construction spending?

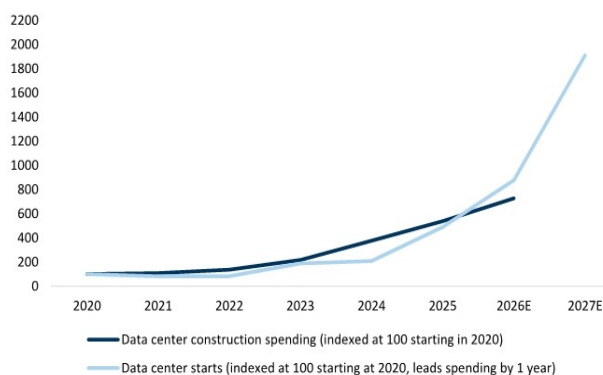
Our favored demand indicators remain broadly consistent in pointing to a path for data center construction spending to reach multiples of current levels. The key uncertainty in our view is timing rather than demand. Permitting delays, power availability, local opposition, and labor constraints can influence when projects move forward and how quickly backlog converts to revenue. However, we believe demand signals, rather than near-term timing considerations, will ultimately drive the direction of our data center infrastructure coverage with investor focus centered on the durability of the data center investment cycle. Below, we walk through our favored data center leading indicators in further detail.

Data center construction starts

Data center construction starts are up 189% yoy on an LTM basis as of July 2026, compared with 118% yoy in June 2026 and 62% yoy in July 2025. While starts work well as an indicator of construction spending over a multi-year period, we note that the near-term data center spending growth outlook (6-12 months) is not necessarily tightly correlated with growth in starts due to a wide variance in project timing. We continue to view starts as an important indicator for assessing demand and directional momentum in data center construction spending, but a less precise gauge of the cadence growth.

Exhibit 3: LTM data center construction spending vs LTM data center starts

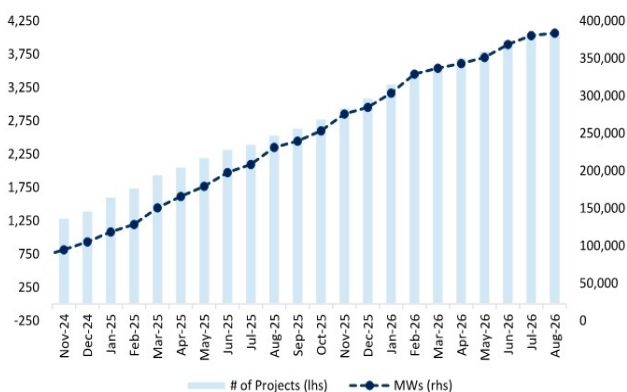
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Dodge Construction Network, Census Bureau

Exhibit 4: Data center construction spending index vs data center starts index (leads by 1 year)

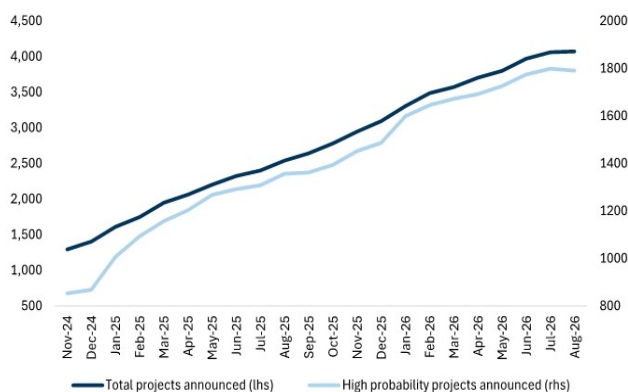
Source: Census Bureau, Dodge Construction Network, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Data center project announcements pending construction

We leverage Aterio's high-frequency tracking of data center developments to assess the trajectory of data center announcements pending construction. Aterio monitors projects using satellite imagery, permits, and filings to validate progress. Data center project announcements continue to trend higher, with announced projects now totaling ~4.5 times the number of projects currently under construction and up 60% yoy (vs +145% yoy in August 2025). We view announcements as an important leading indicator, though not all announced projects ultimately move forward. As a result, we also focus on the trajectory of the subset of announced projects that Aterio classifies as having a high probability of execution. High-probability projects not yet started are up 32% yoy in August 2026 vs 89% in August 2025. High + medium probability projects not yet started are up 66% yoy in August 2026.

Exhibit 5: Data center announcements not yet put into construction

Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: High probability data center project announcements pending construction vs total data center project announcements

Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

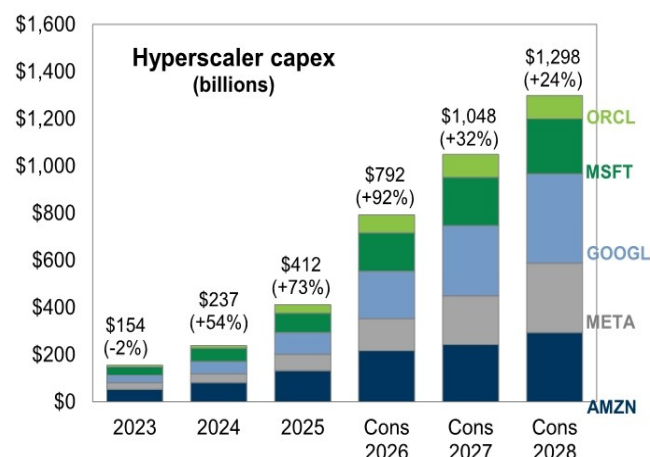
Hyperscaler capex

We continue to monitor our Portfolio Strategy team's hyperscaler capex trackers, which we view as a key leading indicator of future data center construction activity.

Hyperscaler capex typically precedes construction spending, as investment often begins

with GPUs, land acquisition, and other upfront infrastructure needs well before physical construction commences. Hyperscaler capex is now expected to grow ~92% yoy in 2026, and 32% yoy in 2027, suggesting continued multi-year runway for data center construction spending at well above current levels.

Exhibit 7: Analysts now expect nearly \$800 billion in hyperscaler capex this year

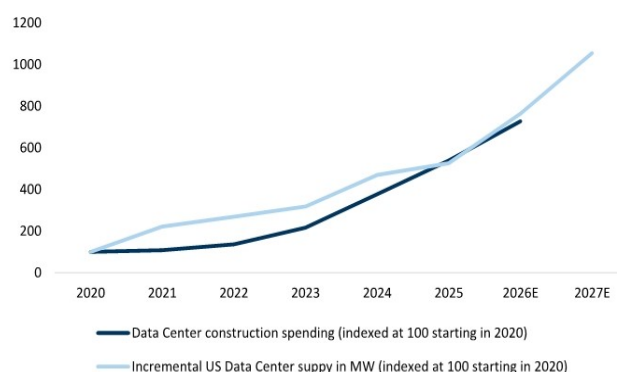


Source: FactSet, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

GS data center capacity forecasts

Our [Global Technology team's forecasts](#) for US data center capacity additions is supportive of significant spending growth in 2027. Historically, incremental capacity additions have tracked closely with construction activity. As such, we look to our Global Technology team's 2027 forecasts for incremental capacity adds as a directional indicator for forward construction spending. Per 451 Research data center project tracking, the team now expects 18,842 MWs of incremental US data center capacity in 2027, representing 38% growth in incremental capacity.

Exhibit 8: Data center construction spending (indexed at 100) vs incremental US data center supply (indexed at 100)



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Census Bureau

Where are data center being built?

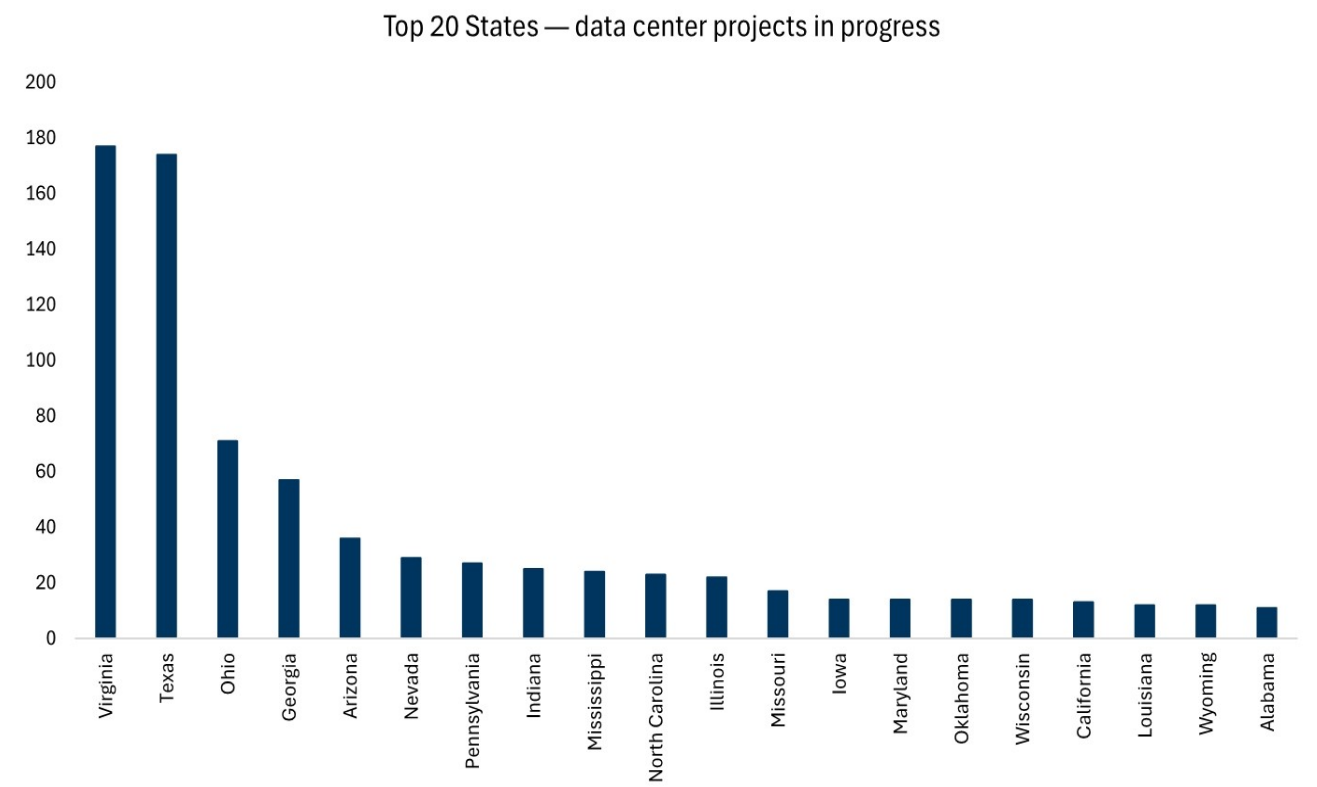
While data center demand remains robust nationally, construction activity is highly bifurcated at the regional level as a result of factors such as power availability, permitting, labor capacity, and local opposition. In this section, we examine where data centers are currently being built, where new projects are being announced, and which geographies are experiencing the fastest growth. We then use these trends to assess the regional positioning of our most data center exposed names and identify which companies are best aligned with the next phase of data center expansion. Our key takeaway is that while data center activity remains concentrated in a handful of established markets, incremental growth is increasingly occurring outside traditional hubs. Virginia remains the largest market today, but announcement growth has moderated, while Texas continues to gain momentum and smaller markets such as Missouri, Oklahoma, Florida, and Michigan are growing rapidly from a low base. These trends favor companies with broader geographic footprints or proven ability to expand markets, workforce mobility, and fabrication capabilities.

The local regulatory backdrop for data center builds remains dynamic. This month, Texas paused approvals for new data center grid interconnection requests while on August 18, 2026, Pennsylvania's Governor signed Executive Order 2026-05, requiring data center developers to make legally binding commitments to compliance with the Governor's Responsible Infrastructure Development (GRID) Requirements. The GS Utilities team recently wrote that it expects the actual impact from these actions on high-quality, large-scale data center developments will be minimal (with potential for some timing risk), with the primary burden falling on speculative, under-capitalized projects. Importantly, both state actions do not affect projects already approved or those planning dedicated on-site generation, which insulates backlog across our coverage.

Where are data centers being built today?

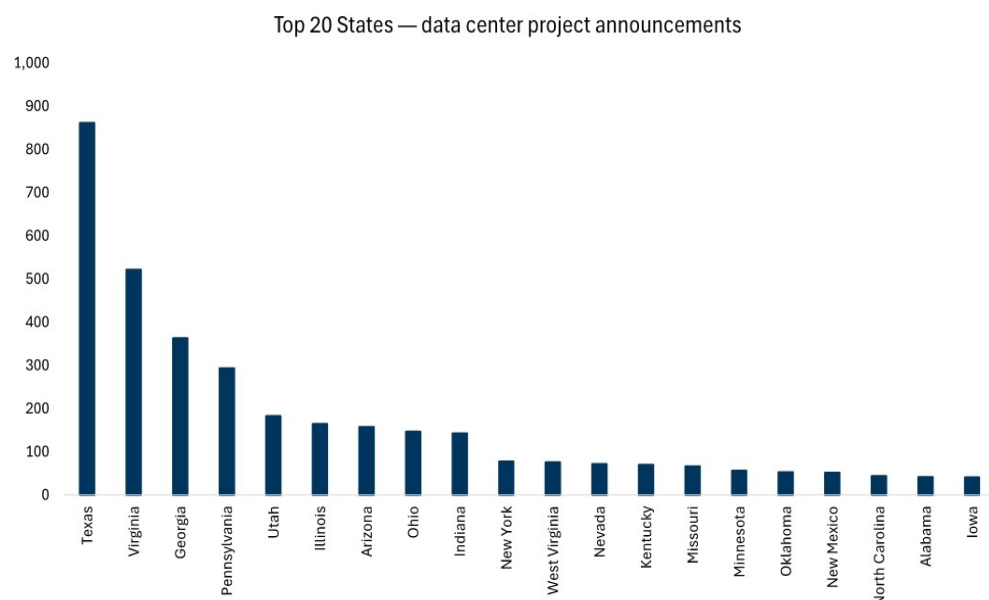
Where are data centers being built? There are more than 875 data centers currently under construction in the U.S., representing ~75 GW of capacity. The top five states by capacity under construction account for nearly 60% of total U.S. data center capacity under construction. Virginia remains the largest market, followed by Texas, Ohio, Georgia, and Arizona. We detail the top 20 states by data center construction activity below.

Exhibit 9: Top 20 States - data center projects in progress



Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Where are data centers being announced? The ranking of project announcements differs somewhat from the in-construction rankings. Texas maintains a significant lead in announced projects, followed by Virginia and Georgia. Interestingly, while Ohio and Arizona rank among the top five states for projects under construction, they fall outside the top five for new project announcements. Instead, Pennsylvania and Utah rank fourth and fifth, respectively, in announced projects. We detail the top 20 states by total data center announcements below.

Exhibit 10: Top 20 States - data center project announcements

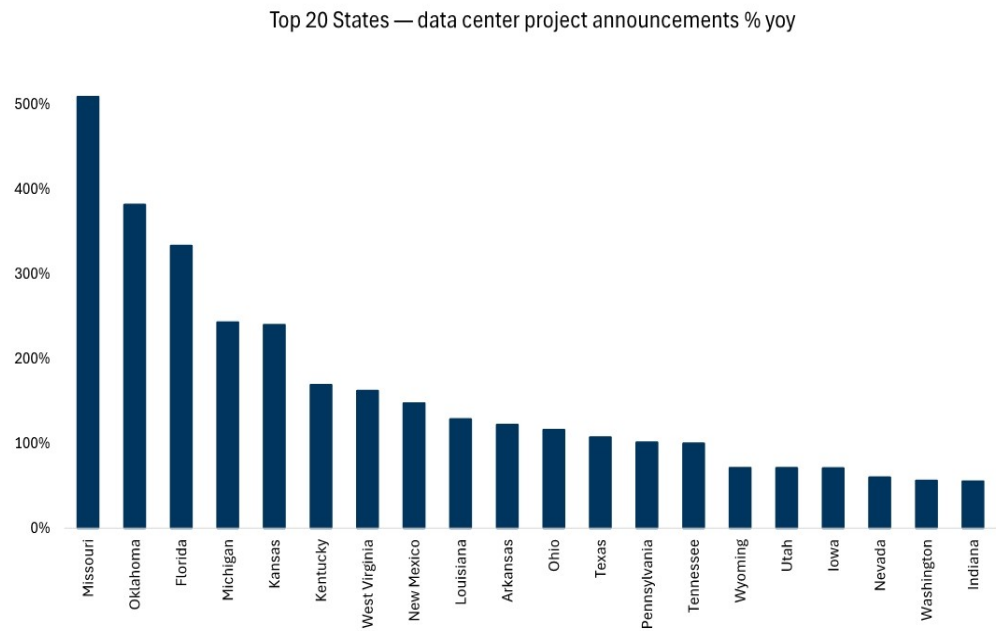
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Aterio

Which regions are seeing the strongest growth in announcements? When we examine growth in project announcements, none of the five largest data center markets by either announced projects or projects under construction rank among the top five fastest growing states. Instead, Missouri, Oklahoma, Florida, Michigan, and Kansas are experiencing the strongest percentage growth in data center announcements, with announced projects increasing by multiples of prior year levels, albeit from a relatively small base.

For context, these five states collectively account for only ~6% of total U.S. data center project announcements totaling ~215 announced projects, compared with more than 860 announcements in Texas alone. As a result, while growth rates in these emerging data center markets are noteworthy, activity remains heavily concentrated in the established data center hubs.

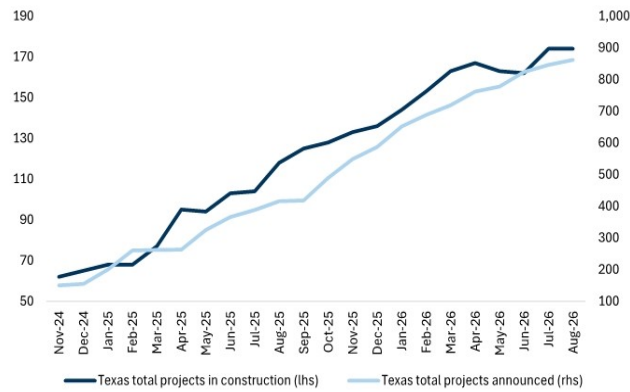
Notably, while Virginia remains the largest data center market by projects under construction and ranks second in total project announcements, growth has begun to moderate. Total project announcements in Virginia increased just 9% yoy in August placing the state outside the top 20 states by announcement growth. Growth across several other established data center markets remains robust, including Texas (+107% yoy), Ohio (+116% yoy), Georgia (+54% yoy), and Arizona (+33% yoy). We detail the top 20 states by data center project announcements growth below.

Exhibit 11: Top 20 States - data center project announcements % yoy



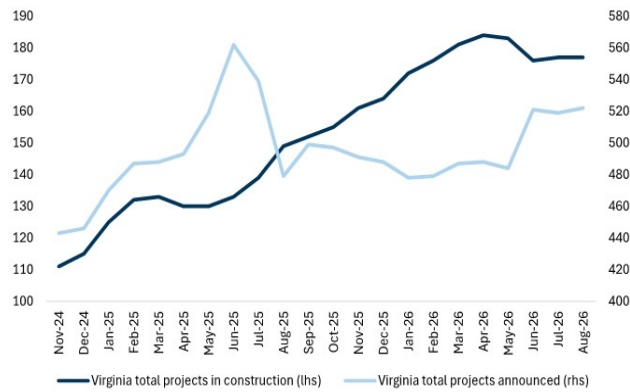
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Aterio

Exhibit 12: Texas total projects in progress vs total projects announced

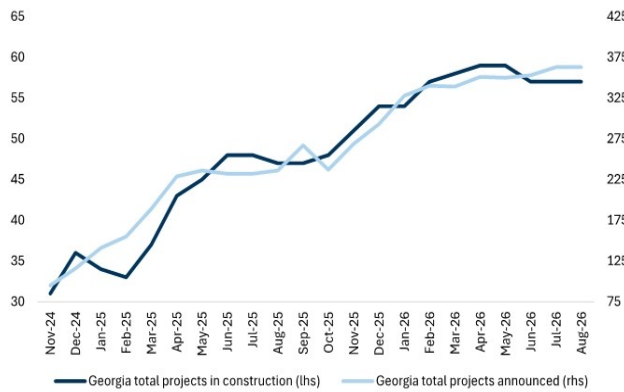


Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

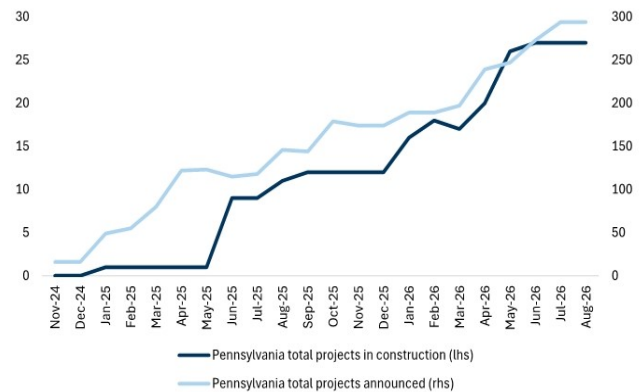
Exhibit 13: Virginia total projects in progress vs total projects announced



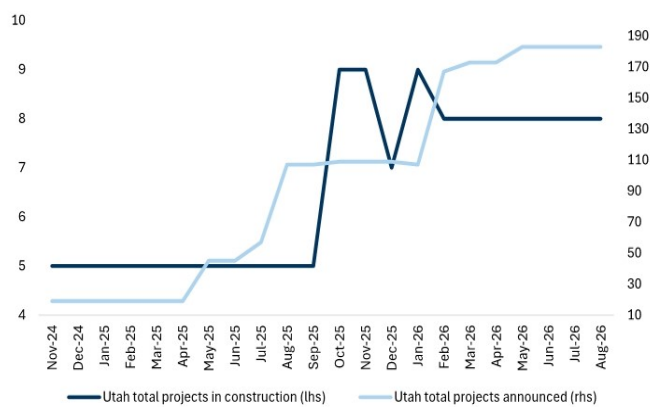
Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: Georgia total projects in progress vs total projects announced

Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: Pennsylvania total projects in progress vs total projects announced

Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: Utah total projects in progress vs total projects announced

Source: Aterio, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Analyzing regional exposure for EME, FIX, LGN

While EME, FIX, and LGN maintain meaningful exposure to data center construction, their geographic positioning is different. Based on our analysis of where capacity is being built and where project announcements are accelerating, we believe EME offers the broadest exposure to major data center markets, FIX provides the greatest leverage to Texas and emerging markets through workforce mobility and fabrication, and LGN's participation in higher-growth regions is increasingly driven by its fabrication platform rather than its local craft labor footprint. As data center development expands beyond a handful of traditional hubs, we believe geographic breadth, the ability to enter new markets, and fabrication capabilities are becoming increasingly important competitive differentiators.

Exhibit 17: Data Center regional exposure summary: FIX, EME

	EME	FIX	LGN
Stated #1 market	Virginia	Texas	DMV
Texas position	~\$1bn non-O&G revenue pre-Schmidt acquisition	~42% of YTD organic growth	Begun to travel into Texas and sells fabrication into Texas
Other named markets	OH, PA, AZ, IN, FL, IA, OK, UT, GA, OR, Chicago, Carolinas	Indiana, Mid-Atlantic, Carolinas, VA, MS, FL	Craft labor in CA, Phoenix; fab ship to IA, OH, NC, GA, UT

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

EME has built one of the broadest data center footprints in our coverage. EME has successfully expanded its data center presence both organically and through M&A, with key markets including Northern Virginia, Texas, Georgia, Ohio, Pennsylvania, Arizona, Indiana/Chicagoland, and the Carolinas. In terms of backlog contribution, Northern Virginia ranks first, Texas second, and Georgia a close third. Based on our analysis of state-level data center development, all three states rank among the top five markets for total project announcements. While growth in Virginia has moderated to the high single digits, project announcements in Texas are up 107% yoy while Georgia announcements have increased 54% yoy.

Texas remains a key growth market, where EME generates ~\$1 bn of non-oil-and-gas revenue prior to the contribution from Schmidt. The company's Central Texas presence originated with the acquisition of Batchelor & Kimball and has since been augmented through additional mechanical acquisitions, providing coverage across both metro and rural markets. EME's Dallas-Fort Worth electrical business has also grown into a top-two market position following an acquisition completed roughly seven years ago, while the Schmidt acquisition further strengthens its presence across Austin, San Antonio, and portions of Houston. The company also has the potential to leverage its existing oil and gas operations to support projects in more remote locations.

FIX has expanded its reach through a combination of fabrication and workforce mobility. Texas remains the company's largest data center market, accounting for ~42% of FIX's YTD organic growth, while Indiana and North Carolina contribute a combined >25% to organic revenue growth. We see FIX as well positioned geographically given its outsized exposure to the Texas market that is the top market in the US in terms of data center project announcements, while the Indiana market is growing >50% yoy, while North Carolina announcement growth has flattened in the last year. Management has also highlighted Virginia as an important market, with activity extending to emerging geographies such as Mississippi and proposed projects in Florida. We view FIX's modular fabrication platform and traveling workforce model as key competitive differentiators. The company's fabrication business now represents ~17% of revenue, up from roughly 10% in 2022, and allows FIX to participate in projects where it lacks a permanent local labor presence. FIX currently operates more than 3.5 million square feet of fabrication capacity and expects to exceed 4 million square feet by year-end, with capacity projected to reach 5 million square feet by late summer 2027. In addition, FIX's acquisition of Kodiak Labor Solutions in 2022 has materially increased workforce mobility. Historically, operating companies worked within a 100-150 mile radius of their local offices; today, ~20% of the workforce can be deployed outside those traditional boundaries, enabling FIX to pursue large-scale projects in markets where labor availability may otherwise be constrained.

LGN's installation workforce focused on 3 core regions, but its fabrication platform expands its addressable market. LGN's key installation markets include California, Phoenix, and the DMV, with management identifying the DMV as its largest data center market. Project announcements are up ~38% yoy in California, 33% yoy in Arizona, and 9% yoy in Virginia. LGN has also begun expanding into Texas through its adjacent New Mexico operations and has started serving a select number of customers in the region. Beyond installation services, LGN's fabrication platform significantly expands its addressable market. Its fabrication capacity allows the company to serve projects in Georgia, Charlotte, Iowa, Ohio, and other markets where it does not maintain a

permanent installation presence. As a result, LGN can participate in data center growth opportunities across a much broader geographic footprint than its local labor base alone would suggest. During 2Q, Legence increased its fabrication capacity by ~200,000 square feet, bringing total capacity to roughly 1.5 million square feet. Management expects to add another 100,000 square feet in the coming weeks and continues to evaluate opportunities for further expansion.

Valuation and risks

Comfort Systems USA (FIX, Buy)

Our 12-month price target of \$2,159 is based on 22x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA. Downside risks include: Slowing Hyperscaler capex, project executions risk and high bar on earnings execution.

Legence (LGN, Buy)

Our 12-month price target of \$95 is based on 15.5x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA. Downside risks include: Slowdown in data center capex spending, Volatility of margins from mix shift, Above average net leverage, Competitive pricing landscape.

EMCOR Group Inc. (EME, Neutral)

Our 12-month price target of \$885 is based on 14.5x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA. Upside risks include: Value-enhancing M&A, Margin improvement ahead of expectations, Market share gains offset slowdown in end market growth. Downside risks include: Slowdown in data center capex spending, Margin volatility, Margin downside, Further slowdown in private non-residential construction spending.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Adam Bubes, CFA and Anuj Khandelwal, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

For a more detailed description of how we calculate the GS Factor Profile, please contact your GS representative.

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Distribution of ratings/investment banking relationships

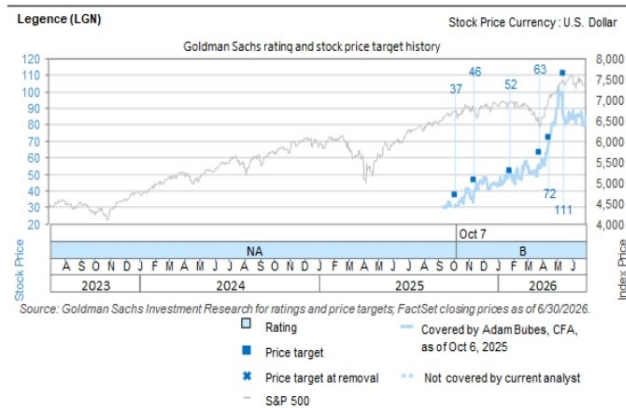
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	Rating Distribution			Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%	65%	59%	43%

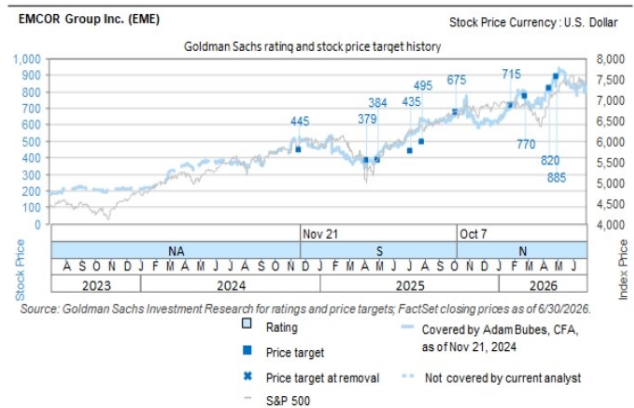
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Relationships chart reflects the percentage of subject companies within each rating category for whom Goldman Sachs has provided investment banking services within the previous twelve months.

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Target price history table(s)

Legence (LGN)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
21-Jul-26	95.00	72.55
15-May-26	111.00	84.30
16-Apr-26	72.00	68.80
27-Mar-26	63.00	54.75
27-Jan-26	52.00	49.94
15-Nov-25	46.00	40.27
07-Oct-25	37.00	32.00

Comfort Systems USA (FIX)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
09-Jul-26	2,159.00	1,781.42

EMCOR Group Inc. (EME)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
31-Jul-26	885.00	797.43
21-Jul-26	825.00	760.27
30-Apr-26	885.00	891.67
16-Apr-26	820.00	792.25
27-Feb-26	770.00	724.62
27-Jan-26	715.00	716.28
07-Oct-25	675.00	673.08
01-Aug-25	495.00	624.67
07-Jul-25	435.00	551.14
01-May-25	384.00	412.52
08-Apr-25	379.00	354.26
21-Nov-24	445.00	526.95

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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